



PROGRESS REPORT

Ethiopia: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-30-2 · 118 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-30.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	Digital Ethiopia 2030 was launched in December 2025 on three pillars of access, equal opportunity and trust, and is the standing national strategy. The strategy sets targets of 128m subscriptions and an identity for every adult by 2030, together with a sevenfold rise in digital payments (Digital Ethiopia 2030). The council overseeing the programme restated in July 2026 that it is to be judged on lives changed rather than systems deployed, a claim with no published measure behind it . No implementation plan, budget allocation against the pillars or progress report is held.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy	The Digital Government Strategy and Enterprise Architecture 2024-2029 has been in force since July 2024 with no revision on the record. The strategy and its enterprise architecture were published in July 2024 and run to 2029, and remain the standing statement of how government systems are to be built (the strategy). The base holds nothing on implementation against it: no progress report, no compliance review and no register of systems assessed against the architecture.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy	A sovereign cloud and a forensic laboratory are named in the national strategy as intentions, with no separate storage or cloud policy held. December 2025's national strategy places a sovereign cloud and a forensic laboratory among the foundations it sets out (Digital Ethiopia 2030). No siting decision, procurement, operator or date exists for either facility, and no data storage or cloud strategy is held as a document in its own right.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap	The e-government interoperability framework has been in development since July 2024 and the base records no completion. The framework was published in July 2024 and is recorded as still in development two years on (the framework). No adopted version, compliance mandate or list of systems built to it is held, which is the gap the approved national data exchange platform would have to close.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	A national artificial intelligence policy adopted in 2024 is in force, known to the base only at second hand. The policy was adopted in 2024 and its existence reaches the base through a July 2026 account of the country joining a Shanghai-based cooperation body (policy in force). The policy text, its objectives, any implementation plan and any review are all absent, so what is recorded is that a policy exists and not what it says.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	A national data governance strategy is being drafted around named use cases in health, agriculture and public financial management. The strategy is being anchored in concrete use cases rather than written first and applied afterwards, with agriculture and public financial management the test domains alongside health (use-case approach). No draft text, adopting instrument or timetable is published, so the approach is on the record and the policy itself is not.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	Proclamation 1321/2024 has been in force since July 2024, a comprehensive regime with extraterritorial reach and no secondary directives behind it. The proclamation took effect on 24 July 2024 as a comprehensive personal data regime reaching beyond the country's borders (Proclamation 1321/2024). What the base does not hold is any instrument under it: the directives that would give the proclamation operative content were still unissued a year after commencement (a year on).	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	Proclamation 1426/2026 designates twelve critical sectors and places eighteen obligations on their owners and operators, commencing about July 2027. The proclamation was signed at Addis Ababa on 21 July 2026, and article 28 sets commencement one year after gazettelement (Proclamation 1426/2026). The designated sectors run from information and communications technology, financial services and transport to agriculture, trade and industry; a Critical Infrastructure Cybersecurity Fund is established, and the security agency is to write sector standards, give technical assistance and enforce through the transition (briefing on the proclamation). Ratification, assent and commencement dates are not established in the base, and the regulations the Council of Ministers and the agency may make under articles 26 and 27 do not yet exist.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id	The Digital Identification Proclamation 1284/2023 is the statute behind the national identity system, in force since April 2023. The proclamation establishes a foundational identification system for the registration of residents, the right of a resident to be identified, a registration system for personal data and the issuance of a unique number, and creates the institution that runs it (proclamation). The held text is the English operative column of a bilingual gazette, complete through article 26; the Amharic column did not survive extraction. No implementing regulation under the proclamation is held, which matters because the base separately records a national identity now mandatory for bank accounts, school enrolment and examinations - obligations the statute itself is the only published authority for.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation	The central bank widened its virtual-asset prohibition to the whole category, and a court struck down a decree revoking licences without a court order. A central-bank public notice of 23 July 2026 widened the prohibition by clarification rather than by new rule, covering use, purchase, sale, exchange, transfer, trading, settlement and facilitation absent express authorisation, with no new regulation and no enforcement mechanism announced (public notice). The Federal High Court of Lideta struck down a December 2025 lottery-administration decree that had cut banking services to betting platforms and gateways, holding revocation of a licence without a court order unconstitutional (the ruling). No payments proclamation or electronic transactions statute is held, so the operative law reaches the base as directives, notices and one judgment.	MIXED the central bank widened a prohibition by notice while a court struck down a decree
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability	No instrument compels agencies to integrate with the unified service platform, on its own regional executives' account. Regional executives of the unified public-service platform say no legal framework obliges agencies to join it, so integration rests on agreement between them (platform review). The base holds no interoperability proclamation, no data-sharing regulation and no mandate under the e-government interoperability framework, which has itself been in development since 2024.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations		NO EVIDENCE

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Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation	A draft amendment would add service provider duties, site blocking and take-down notices to the 2004 copyright proclamation, the first platform-liability instrument held. The intellectual property authority reported in August 2026 that the amendment is being drafted after several consultation rounds, and would put duties on internet service providers, set procedures for blocking infringing sites and create a rights-holder take-down notice (the authority's account). Enforcement would stay rights-holder-initiated and by web address, because channel operators cannot be identified, against existing remedies of one-to-ten-year sentences and fines to 25,000 Birr (the same report). A draft proclamation ratifying accession to the Berne Convention is before the Council of Ministers, with no parliamentary date published (the report again).	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation	The state development bank adopted a policy classifying client credit information and four other categories as permanently non-disclosable. The policy, reported in August 2026, exempts client credit information, legal case files, strategy papers, security protocols and third-party contracts from declassification where disclosure could cause substantial harm to the bank, its stakeholders or the national interest, and lets the bank decline requests that would require it to create records it does not hold (disclosure policy). No instrument number, gazette reference or appeal mechanism is stated, and the base holds no general access-to-information statute against which to read it.	REGRESSED
Data protection	Data protection authority	The communications authority is the designated regulator, and a year after commencement it had taken no enforcement action. The proclamation names the Ethiopian Communications Authority as regulator rather than creating a dedicated body (Proclamation 1321/2024). A year after commencement the authority had yet to enforce and public awareness was low, on a base where the national identity authenticates about 4m times a day across more than 150 agencies (a year on). No budget, staffing figure, register of controllers or decision of any kind is held for the authority in its data-protection role.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data protection	National data protection readiness	No independent impact assessment, redress mechanism or statutory limit on state access to the identity system is held, against 46.5m registrations. A published critique argues the identity system risks becoming an instrument of mass profiling in the absence of independent data-protection impact assessments, meaningful citizen rights and legal limits on state access (critique). In August 2026 the foreign ministry circulated a note asking every accredited diplomatic mission and international organisation to submit lists and addresses of all Ethiopian and foreign employees without diplomatic privileges, together with tenant and landlord details (diplomatic note). No legal basis, retention rule, data controller or purpose limitation is stated in the note as reported. The regulator now says the secondary law is coming: four directives are expected to be approved in the coming months and a registration portal for data controllers and processors has been previewed , an early step towards a national register of them. The directives are unpublished, the portal was shown at a workshop co-hosted with a vendor, and a year after the proclamation took effect nothing has been enforced under it.	REGRESSED
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	Identity cooperation was agreed with Zambia in March 2026, and a three-year memorandum with Mozambique followed in April. The Mozambique memorandum was signed at Addis Ababa on 27 April 2026 between Mozambique's digital transformation agency and the Ethiopian state digital-identity enterprise, and is extendable by consent (memorandum). Under it the Ethiopian side provides digital-identity, pilot, interoperability and joint-cybersecurity support, coordinated through a joint working group (trade account). The Zambian arrangement is recorded only as identity cooperation agreed, with no text, term or scope on the record (Zambia integrator search).	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure	A terrestrial corridor with Djibouti, Sudan and Saudi Arabia entered active deployment in August 2026, having become binding in February. The December 2024 memorandum between the three national operators became a binding agreement in February 2026 (binding agreement). By August the end-to-end solution architecture was finalised and site-material procurement complete, with the stated route extended to Jeddah (deployment). No route length, cost, in-service date or transit-revenue projection is published, so the transit-hub claim rests on the corridor's geography alone, and one of the four territories it crosses is at war.	ADVANCED
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers	A bilateral health memorandum provides for a data-sharing arrangement still to be negotiated, expected to run two years beyond its five-year term. Clause 2.5.2 of the December 2025 memorandum has the two governments intending to negotiate an arrangement for exchanging data on long-term performance and for accountability to the United States Congress, and clause 4.7 makes failure to fulfil the specimen and data sharing arrangements grounds for changing or discontinuing assistance, although the memorandum creates no specimen arrangement (memorandum). A rights organisation reading the seven signed memoranda puts Ethiopia among five whose text requires unilateral sharing of specimens and pathogen-sequencing data, and all seven as requiring broad audit access (assessment); no arrangement text is published, and a subset posted by the State Department in March 2026 was removed (records complaint).	ADVANCED
Standards	National interoperability standards		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Standards	National quality standards	National livestock data standards were endorsed in July 2026 and cascaded through training of trainers to more than 300 experts and collectors. The standards were developed with the agriculture ministry, endorsed, and then cascaded on a training-of-trainers model (livestock data standards). They underpin a livestock information system drawing on five priority databases, which repositions animal identification from an export tool to a national asset register and links it to disease surveillance and vaccination records (the same account). The account is the implementing organisation's own, after four years with a team embedded in the ministry, and is uncorroborated in the base.	ADVANCED
Standards	Adoption of international standards	The national identity is built on an open-source international platform and is the reference deployment other implementations point to. The platform is modular open source under the Mozilla Public Licence, incubated at a research institute in Bangalore, and the Ethiopian deployment is its flagship (platform account). That adoption is the base's clearest evidence of an international standard taken up, and its only one: no conformity assessment, standards-body membership or certification against international instruments is on the record.	NO CHANGE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	A civil-society project on climate disinformation launched in August 2026 will track government communications ahead of the November climate conference. The project covers Uganda and Ethiopia under a wider international initiative, and combines research mapping how climate disinformation spreads and who drives it with a fact-checking masterclass at the 2026 internet-freedom forum and online training for journalists and civil society (project launch). No budget or duration is stated, and the base holds no other instance of non-governmental input to national digital policy: no consultation record, no submission and no published response to one.	ADVANCED
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	Public argument over telecommunications reform has moved from whether to liberalise to whether the state is provider or regulator. The monopoly ended in 2021 with one new full licensee since, and the published debate now turns on whether the state should act as provider or as regulator and partner (reform commentary). That is the only held instance of open policy argument, and it is a newspaper commentary rather than a consultation, a hearing record or a government response to either.	NO CHANGE

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	Digital lines in the federal budget rose to ETB 9.05bn for FY2026/27 from ETB 3.75bn, dominated by a single university project. Thirty-four digital budget lines run across three years: ETB 1.21bn appropriated in FY2024/25 against an outturn of ETB 1.53bn, ETB 3.75bn in FY2025/26 and ETB 9.05bn in FY2026/27, the last dominated by an artificial-intelligence university line (budget lines). They sit inside a federal budget of 2.34 trillion birr for FY2026/27, ratified in July 2026 and up 21.3% on the year before (budget ratified). Execution is now published: the mid-year review for 2025/26 records ETB 704.7bn mobilised, 48.1% of the annual target, against ETB 798.2bn spent, 48.3% of the approved budget, with recurrent spending at 39.3% of its budget against 62.9% of capital (mid-year review).	ADVANCED mostly the birr float rather than real growth
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships		NO EVIDENCE
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	The second network operator is funded to about US\$2.67bn, and a change of control over it completed in June 2026. The parent's disclosure at 30 June 2026 puts funding of the Ethiopian operator at KES 345.7bn, about US\$2.672bn: KES 298.3bn of equity and KES 47.3bn of debt from a commercial bank and the International Finance Corporation, including the US\$850m licence fee and the US\$150m mobile-money fee (funding disclosure). A funding round restricted to one shareholder family lifted the lead holding to 54.1% in March 2026 from 51.67%, cutting the two development financiers to 9.5% and 6.81% with a right to reacquire what they lost (the same disclosure). The incumbent's 10% public share offer closed in February 2025, distributed through its wallet (public offer), and the change of control completed on 30 June 2026 (completion).	ADVANCED

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New investments	Development-partner project financing	The US\$350m identity credit is rated satisfactory on both counts and 23% disbursed, and a small extension grant was committed in July 2026. The identity project is an SDR 228.2m credit of US\$300m plus an SDR 38.1m grant of US\$50m from the window for host communities and refugees (appraisal). The March 2026 implementation support mission rated it satisfactory on development objective and on implementation progress, with 23% disbursed and US\$46.4m disbursed since the start of the 2026 financial year (aide-memoire). A US\$300,000 grant committed in July 2026 converts a catalytic start-up initiative into a programme delivering agricultural extension through digital channels to 2028 (extension grant).	ADVANCED

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	The incumbent reports 99.8% population coverage on about 90m subscribers, and the second operator 14.7m active customers. Mobile connections reached 93.2m in late 2025, 68.4% of the population, from 85.4m and 63.8% in early 2025 (connections). The incumbent reported 99.8% population coverage in April 2026 (coverage), and the second operator 14.7m ninety-day active customers in August after upgrading more than 67 sites across nine southern towns against congestion and power problems (site upgrades). Contracts signed at the 2026 industry congress cover 1,500 new sites and 502 upgrades from one vendor and 647 from another, under a three-year corporate strategy to 2028 (expansion contracts , strategy); a review in August put 879 sites complete under the second programme (progress review).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Internet usage	Data and internet became the incumbent's largest revenue line in the year to June 2026, at 31.1% against mobile voice at 23.5%. It was the first financial year in which data and internet, not mobile voice, were the largest share of the incumbent's revenue (data overtakes voice). Total revenue was 215.8bn birr with operating profit of 92.9bn birr, on the operator's own unaudited figures (results). A streaming service and a zero-touch broadband product launched in February 2026 (new services). No independent measure of internet use is held: the base carries revenue mix and connection counts, not a survey of users.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Mobile affordability		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	The second operator began building fibre from Afdera to Mekelle in August 2025, the only backbone construction the base holds. Construction on that route started in August 2025 and is the only record of national fibre being built by anyone other than the incumbent (fibre deployment). No route length, capacity, cost or completion date is published, and the base holds no figure at all for the national backbone's route kilometres, its utilisation or its redundancy.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth	A multi-terabit corridor to Jeddah through Djibouti and Sudan entered deployment, the first new international route the base holds. The corridor is described as multi-terabit and now runs to Saudi Arabia, which would give a landlocked country a second path to international capacity alongside its existing transit (corridor deployment). No capacity figure, in-service date or price is published, and the base holds no measurement of international bandwidth in use, per person or in total, against which to read it.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	Satellite services are licensable as a class landing-right authorisation, and no low-earth-orbit operator is authorised on the record. The licensing directive of July 2021 carries a class authorisation for satellite voice, internet and data services provided without infrastructure or a network facility in the country, one of thirteen class licences alongside internet service provider, data centre, hosting and terminal authorisations (licensing directive). There is no orbit-specific determination and no authorised operator on record, and the regulator denied in July 2025 that any discussions with a low-earth-orbit operator had taken place (the same record).	NO CHANGE
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	The country is named among markets diversifying Africa's estate, with no capacity figure of its own on the record. A July 2026 survey of African capacity names Ethiopia alongside Nigeria, Kenya, Egypt, Ghana and Morocco as markets diversifying an estate in which South Africa holds more than 60% of operational capacity (capacity survey). No megawatt figure, facility count or pipeline is given for Ethiopia itself, so the base records that the country is on the list and nothing about where on it.	NO CHANGE a first mention with no capacity figure behind it
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)	An in-country cloud exchange went live in April 2026, selling compute, Kubernetes and storage priced in birr and hybrid with two global clouds. The platform offers compute, Kubernetes, drive and security services priced in local currency and interoperating with two global cloud providers, and its operator frames it as compliance with local data rules (cloud exchange). No capacity, customer count or price list is published, and the base holds no other nationally operated cloud or data centre, so this is the whole of the domestic-provider record.	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres	A 40 MW bitcoin-mining site was completed in January 2026 with 20 MW more in progress, drawn by cheap electricity. The operator completed 40 MW at the Oromia site with a further 20 MW under construction, having weighed Nigeria for the same project before relocating it on far cheaper electricity (mining site). The load is a mining site rather than a data centre serving domestic compute, and the base holds nothing on water, on grid capacity reserved for such loads, or on the tariff the electricity is sold at.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	Grid reliability	Diesel generator running time across the incumbent's network is down by up to 40% on hybrid solar and battery installations. The operator reports 867 hybrid solar-and-battery systems and 1,114 lithium-ion storage units across its network, cutting diesel generator running time by up to 40% (green operator). The figures are the operator's own and unaudited, and they measure a network's dependence on its own backup rather than the grid itself: no outage statistics, interruption indices or utility disclosure are held.	ADVANCED
Energy	Rural electrification	Solar on the incumbent's network reached 39.72 MW, against rural electricity reaching 9% of community health workers. Installed solar across the incumbent's network stood at 39.72 MW in August 2026, up 12.72 MW over the financial year, on 190 fully solar-powered sites serving rural and off-grid communities (green operator). Behind that, the community health information system is offline-first by necessity because rural electricity reaches 9% of its users and fourth-generation coverage 4%, and the ministry distributed about 29,950 power banks with its tablets (community health system).	MIXED solar at network sites is rising while rural electricity behind the community health system stays at 9%
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software	Services are onboarded to the unified platform before the underlying systems are digitised, on two incompatible integration models. The platform's own regional executives say services are being onboarded ahead of the digitisation of the systems that would serve them, and that two incompatible integration models have emerged as a result (platform review). The base holds no inventory of government hardware or software, no uptime figure for any government system and no assessment of the estate, so the platform's own account is the only evidence on the question.	MIXED services are being added to the unified platform ahead of the systems behind them
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems	The national health information system stayed online on local staffing after the 2025 aid freeze, while donor-funded livestock and zoonotic surveillance was suspended. The 2025 United States aid freeze suspended livestock and zoonotic surveillance, while the national health information system continued to run on local staffing, which is the argument its implementers draw for locally owned routine systems (a year after the freeze). The contrast is the only direct evidence held on national capacity to keep government systems running, and it covers one sector: no civil-service skills audit, vacancy figure or maintenance contract register is on file.	MIXED the national health information system held on local staffing while donor-funded surveillance stopped

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	Cybersecurity foundations are named in the national strategy, and the dominant state bank is moving to a zero-trust architecture. The December 2025 strategy makes the security agency's cybersecurity work one of the foundations of the national programme (Digital Ethiopia 2030). The dominant state bank reported in August 2026 that it is moving its information-systems architecture to a zero-trust model supported by artificial intelligence (financial sector threats). No national readiness assessment, incident statistics, emergency response team disclosure or sectoral audit is held, so the record is a stated intention and one institution's own account.	ADVANCED

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	A national data exchange platform was approved by a prime-ministerial board in July 2026, paired with a predictive model and not yet built. The board approved the platform alongside an artificial-intelligence predictive model, at the same meeting that was diagnosing the absence of an interoperability layer (board approval). Nothing is published on architecture, budget, timetable or operator, and the interoperability framework that would govern such a platform has itself been in development since 2024, so approval is the whole of the position.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems	The identity has been integrated with tax administration since December 2023 and was made mandatory for schooling in November 2025. Tax administration was integrated with the national identity in December 2023 and the base records no change since (tax integration). The mandate of November 2025 requires the identity for school enrolment and for sitting examinations (education mandate). Neither integration is described in technical terms: there is no statement of what is exchanged, under what authority, or whether the exchange runs through a shared layer or point to point.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems	Health is the most fragmented sector on the record, at more than 70 siloed platforms and 200 pilots, converging on one record-interoperability pilot. Work on the data governance strategy surfaced health as the most fragmented sector, holding more than 70 siloed platforms and more than 200 pilots, and it is converging on a multi-tenant electronic medical record interoperability pilot (use cases). The pilot has no published scope, participating facilities or date, and the base holds no health information exchange, no terminology standard and no patient identifier arrangement.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	The programme adopted an open external assessment framework as its official monitoring instrument and re-ran it in May 2026. The assessment was first run in early 2025 and re-run in May 2026, and the identity programme has adopted it as its official monitoring instrument rather than commissioning its own (assessment). The scores, findings and any remediation plan are not held, so the base records that the system is being measured and not what the measurement says. The deployment is the flagship implementation of the platform it is built on, which other national programmes take as their reference (platform account).	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population	Enrolment reached 49.1m by August 2026 from 16.4m in June 2025, on 12,000 registration kits, against a 90m target. Enrolments stood at 49.1m on 24 August 2026, from about 46.5m in July and 16.4m in June 2025, on 12,000 biometric registration kits deployed nationally (enrolment count). The incumbent operator accounts for 69% of all registrations, about 32m people since April 2024, of which 20.19m in the year to June 2026, with 9.35m cards printed against about 9.4m ordered (operator channel). The second operator took two lots of the registration project in July 2026, covering Afar, Amhara, Tigray, Sidama and three southern regions (registration lots), and a four-lot procurement of about US\$54m for registration super agents awaits the lender's clearance (aide-memoire).	ADVANCED

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Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems	The identity programme was incorporated as a state-owned enterprise in August 2026 under the sovereign wealth fund, and plans to widen its wallet. The programme was commercialised into the sovereign wealth fund with a 10bn birr cap in March 2026 (wealth fund), then incorporated as a state-owned enterprise on 4 August 2026 with the programme's executive director appointed chief executive (enterprise). The holding company states the purpose as attracting partnerships and creating long-term value, and positions the enterprise for export (the same account). The wallet is planned to carry academic transcripts, professional licences, healthcare records, property titles and compliance data beyond the government credentials it holds today, with no timetable, consent model, controller arrangement or regulatory approval stated (wallet expansion).	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	194m identity verifications have been performed across 150 integrated agencies, and biometric kits have gone to banks. The programme reports 194m electronic know-your-customer verifications to date across 150 integrated agencies, on its own unaudited figures (verification count). Two thousand portable face, fingerprint and iris kits were distributed to 31 banks in November 2025 of 6,000 planned, at about US\$17m, with the remaining 4,000 under a re-issued tender (biometric kits). No authentication failure rate, exception-handling procedure or availability figure is published.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems	All bank accounts were required to be harmonised with the identity by March 2026, and one bank now opens accounts on it alone. The December 2025 directive required every bank account to be harmonised with the national identity by 30 March 2026 (banking integration). A commercial bank opened the first accounts on the identity alone in April 2026, without other documents (remote account opening). Nothing is held on compliance with the deadline: no share of accounts harmonised, no extension and no enforcement action is on the record.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The central bank published a five-year payments strategy in December 2025 and directed the banking system to harmonise accounts with the national identity. The strategy for 2026 to 2030 was published against 18.5tn birr a year in digital transactions (payments strategy). The following day the bank set a March 2026 deadline for full integration of the national identity with the banking system (banking integration). The bank's supervisory record is thinner than its strategy: no licensing register, supervisory report or consumer-complaint statistics are held.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	A mobile wallet began collecting regional tax in July 2026, described as the first of a planned series with regional revenue authorities. The service went live with one regional revenue authority in July 2026 (regional tax payment). No collection volume, taxpayer count or fee arrangement is published, and the base holds nothing on federal revenue collected through digital channels, which is the larger question.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	An instant payment system launched in February 2026 across 32 banks and 12 microfinance institutions, with merchant and cash-out services added since. The national instant payment system carries account-to-account and wallet-to-wallet transfers with a national quick-response standard and aliases (instant payments). The switch behind it links the challenger wallet to more than 30 banks and wallets in real time, with merchant payments at more than 50,000 merchants (switch integration). Cardless cash withdrawals with one bank went live in August 2026, authorised in the app before cash is dispensed (cardless withdrawals), and prepaid electricity became purchasable in the wallet in July (electricity payments).	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	The incumbent's wallet reports 60.6m users and 4.19tn birr transacted in the year to June 2026, against 2.58m monthly active users on the challenger. The incumbent's wallet moved 4.19tn birr in the year to June 2026, about 11bn birr a day, across 60.6m users, 410,700 agents and 440,100 merchants, with 21.64m customers on digital credit and microfinance (wallet results). The challenger reports monthly active users doubled to 2.58m in the quarter to June 2026 and registered merchants up 147.7% to 89,877, while mobile money is about 2% of the unit's service revenue against 45.6% in Kenya (quarterly results); the base also holds 5.2m active users for the quarter to December 2025, and the two counts are not reconciled (earlier count). The dominant state bank reports 3.48 billion digital transactions worth more than 22 trillion birr in 2025/26, which it puts at about 70 per cent of national digital transaction value (bank figures). The Global Findex 2025 reading puts account ownership at 49 per cent of adults in 2024, up three points from 46 per cent in 2021 , against more than 200 million digital accounts opened over the period, with financial literacy, limited smartphone access and physical distance named as what still excludes. Accounts opened and adults included move in opposite directions and nothing reconciles the two.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	International card acceptance went live through the national switch in November 2025, and the payments strategy proposes first outbound transfers. The national switch and an international card network brought international acceptance live in November 2025 (card acceptance). The payments strategy published a fortnight later proposes the country's first outbound cross-border transfers, which are not currently permitted (payments strategy). No transaction volume, corridor or remittance figure is held, and the base records nothing on inbound remittance channels, which are the larger cross-border flow.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Population register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Civil register	A Civil and Family Registration Proclamation was gazetted in March 2025, seating the function in the immigration and citizenship service. The proclamation regulates civil and family registration, defines vital events as birth, marriage and the rest, seats the function in the Immigration and Citizenship Service, provides for registration at health institutions and on board Ethiopian ships, and sets where and when a civil registration may and may not be entered (proclamation). The gazette itself is the held record. No registration coverage figure, implementing directive or statement of what the proclamation changed in practice is held, so the register's reach is unestablished.	ADVANCED
Registries	Address register	A digital addressing system is being prepared for three southern cities under an agreement signed in December 2025. The space science and geospatial institute signed an entry agreement with the South Ethiopia regional land administration bureau, the administrations of Arba Minch, Jinka and Wolayita Sodo and a university to prepare and implement the system in those three cities (agreement). The institute's own news page is the held record, retrieved from a web archive after its domain failed to resolve. No budget, timetable, address count or national plan beyond the three cities is stated.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Business register	An online registration and licensing platform cut eleven steps and 32 days to two steps and two days, and delivered 2.9 million services in nine months. The platform replaces eleven steps taking up to 32 days with two steps inside two days, integrating the revenue ministry, the national identification agency, federal document verification and quality certification, with payment through the national switch (platform). The trade ministry delivered 2,936,270 registration and licensing services online in the first nine months of 2025/26, 109 per cent of its target and 12 per cent up on the year before . That is a count of services delivered, not of businesses registered, and no processing-time measurement against the two-day claim is published. A separate state account puts 2.7 million businesses on a digital database with no methodology behind it.	ADVANCED
Registries	Social protection register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Electoral register	The election board inaugurated a voter and candidate registration system in January 2026 and registered more than 50.5 million voters by April. The board inaugurated the system on 5 January 2026, developed in-house under the innovation and technology pillar of its five-year plan (inauguration). Candidate registration ran from 9 January to 8 February 2026 and voter registration from 7 March, with citizens registering either through a mobile application or in person at polling stations; more than 50,514,000 voters had registered when the process closed on 22 April after an extension (registration). The board's own accounts are the whole of the record. No split between application and in-person registration, duplicate rate, or data-protection arrangement for the register is published, and no earlier register size is held for comparison.	ADVANCED
Registries	Tax register		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	Land register	A cloud-hosted land services platform integrated with the national identity and payment systems is in service, with nothing published about its reach. The platform carries document upload, electronic signature and online payment, is integrated with the national identity and payment systems, and offers a mobile interface for citizens and officials (platform). Its own site is the held record, retrieved from a web archive after the domain failed to resolve. No parcel count, city coverage or operator is established, and a land platform whose domain does not resolve is itself the finding.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Health	The national health information system covers more than 95% of facilities at an assessed maturity of 2.81 of 5, weakest on infrastructure. The district health information system has been national since 2018 and reaches more than 95% of facilities, at a maturity of 2.81 out of 5 with information and communications infrastructure weakest at 2.14 (maturity assessment). Functionality for comparing reports received against reports expected was available in 75.0% of the data offices assessed in a four-country study run between November 2022 and July 2024 (newborn data functionality). The community system reaches about 40,000 health extension workers (community health system), and a case-management system used by 950 community health workers reports data-access time down from a month to a day (case management). A bilateral memorandum allocates US\$18,850,149 to health data systems across 2026 to 2030, with Ethiopia carrying licensing, cloud, hardware and maintenance costs (memorandum).	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Education		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection	The country's largest safety net has run since 2005, with no registry, targeting system or payment mechanism described anywhere in the base. The programme was launched in 2005 to address chronic food insecurity through public works, employment guarantee and direct job creation alongside education, health and water interventions, and was extended in 2009 to meet growing needs (programme). A partnership platform's profile is the held record. No beneficiary registry, targeting system, payment mechanism or link to the national identity is described. For the largest transfer programme in the country that absence is the finding: the base can say the programme exists and nothing about the data system that would have to run it.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	Justice	The Federal Supreme Court president approved an electronic appeals and litigation directive for all federal courts, in effect from November 2025. The directive takes the federal judicial system digital, applies to all federal courts and came into effect in November 2025, approved on grounds of cutting spending and improving efficiency (directive). A newspaper account retrieved from a web archive is the held record. The directive text is not held and no filing volume, court coverage or provision for litigants without access is established.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Tax	A revenue audit rested on data conflating gateway throughput with gateway revenue, restating one firm's three-year volume more than fourfold. Data compiled for a revenue audit conflated gross transaction volume with gateway revenue, restating one gateway's three-year throughput of ETB 32bn as ETB 143.9bn and taxing the difference at 30% (tax assessment). Corrected datasets issued in April 2026 were not accepted, and ETB 818m was swept from frozen accounts in May against a liability counsel puts at ETB 20-30m, with parallel sweeps against two other gateways (the same account). The overstatement exceeds ETB 111bn, against a gateway commission of about 2.5% split with the state operator (the account again). An international diagnostic of February 2025, across nine performance outcome areas, found the absence of a robust integrated tax administration information system adversely affecting the integrity of the registered taxpayer base, with online registration and updating of taxpayer details sought, electronic payment facilities not in place, and the use of electronic filing carried as an indicator in its own right (diagnostic). It is the only independent assessment of the administration's systems the base holds, and it predates the audit recorded above. An administration assessed as lacking an integrated system, and then producing a revenue assessment that conflated throughput with revenue, is one account read against the other.	REGRESSED
Sectoral management information systems	Customs		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Land	A farmer profile database is being built across 311 woredas, integrated with the national identity and the rural land systems. The agricultural transformation institute is building the database with the agriculture ministry to make farmer data reusable and interoperable for digital extension and advisory services, initially targeting 311 agricultural commercialisation cluster woredas with nationwide expansion planned, and integrated with the national identity and rural land systems (initiative). The institute's own project page is the held record. No farmer count enrolled, data-protection arrangement or consent basis is stated for a database keyed to the national identity. It would sit alongside a land services platform that is itself integrated with the identity system, and nothing states how the two relate.	ADVANCED
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	The unified platform's own catalogue lists more than 180 services from 23 organisations, against 41 services and 12 agencies a year earlier. The public catalogue, read in August 2026, states more than 180 government services from 23 named provider organisations, each listed with required documents, processing time and fees (service catalogue). A government communication of April 2026 claims 2,260 services integrated, two months before the 185 stated at the June launch, so the two counts run concurrently on different bases rather than showing a rise (government communication , platform launch). Electronic government procurement is credited by the Auditor General with the decline in cash shortages across 163 audited federal institutions, in a report that also finds billions of Birr uncollected (audit report). An unmanned police station opened in March 2026 with self-service kiosks for reports, fines and document requests (police station). The transport and logistics ministry launched three national systems with the incumbent operator: a cross-country public transport service system, an integrated fuel supply system and a national traffic point-based penalty management system . A trade magazine account of the launch is the record; no coverage, volume or data-handling rule for a penalty system keyed to drivers is published.	ADVANCED

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government	The capital reports 11 one-stop digital service centres carrying more than 150 services from more than 25 integrated institutions. At the close of the 2025/26 financial year the city administration reported 11 centres offering more than 150 services drawn from more than 25 integrated institutions (one-stop centres). The figures are the operator's own, given by the centre's director general to the city administration's own media network, with no transaction volumes, users served, cost, uptime or independent evaluation published, and the base holds nothing at all on any other subnational tier.	ADVANCED
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations		NO EVIDENCE

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration	The state artificial intelligence institute, established in 2020, built the unified service platform and anchors the state's capability claim. The institute has operated since 2020 and is credited with building the unified public-service platform, which is the state's principal claim to applied artificial intelligence capability (the institute). Nothing else is held: no inventory of models in government use, no procurement, no evaluation of any deployed system and no policy on automated decision-making within administration.	NO CHANGE
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems	Generative artificial intelligence services are sold as bundles through a mobile wallet, and no nationally developed model is held. Bundles for generative application, website, game, video and music creation went on sale in July 2026 through the challenger's wallet, bought with mobile money and redeemed by voucher (service bundles). The base holds no nationally or regionally developed model, no training dataset, no compute facility and no research output, so what is recorded is the distribution of services built elsewhere.	ADVANCED
AI	Control of AI abuse		NO EVIDENCE
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	The base names one domestic engineering firm and one foreign entrant with a local partner, with no measure of national production. An Addis Ababa engineering services firm founded in 2021 is the only named domestic producer on the record (engineering firm). A South African financial-technology firm entered the payments market in August 2026 with a local engineering partner, aligning onboarding, fraud-management and workflow-automation tools with the national payments strategy, with no commitment value, customer or deployment date disclosed (market entry). No industry survey, employment figure, export value or firm count is held.	NO CHANGE two firms named and no output measured
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs	An artificial intelligence innovation pod opened in February 2026, run with a development agency and the national university. The pod opened in February 2026 with the United Nations Development Programme and Addis Ababa University (innovation pod). It is the only hub the base holds: no incubator count, membership figure, funding total or record of what has come out of it is on file.	ADVANCED
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	An Ethiopian-founded authentication company closed a US\$5 million seed round led by international venture investors in June 2025. The open-source authentication company closed the round with international venture investors behind it, building developer-owned authentication (round). A local technology outlet's account is the held record. The company's operations, staff location and whether any of the capital or the work lands in Ethiopia are not established, so this is a founder story rather than an evidenced domestic sector position. The base holds no start-up funding series, hub inventory or venture register against which to place it.	ADVANCED

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)		NO EVIDENCE
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	ETB 5bn was appropriated in the FY2026/27 budget to build an artificial intelligence university, with no site or timetable published. The appropriation is ETB 5,000,000,000, carried as a single named capital project in the federal budget ratified in July 2026 (budget line , budget ratified). Nothing is published on site, design, intake, faculty or opening date, and the base holds no enrolment figure, graduate count or course inventory for any digital qualification at any existing institution.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem		NO EVIDENCE
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy	A university law school is drafting the online-infringement amendment with the intellectual property authority. The amendment to the copyright proclamation is being drafted with the Addis Ababa University School of Law after several rounds of consultation (drafting). That is the whole of the record: no think tank, research centre or academic department is otherwise named as contributing to digital policy, and no commissioned research, submission or advisory appointment is held.	ADVANCED

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Gender equity	The rural mobile-internet gender gap is put at 81%, against 29% in urban areas. The gap between men's and women's mobile internet use is reported at 81% in rural areas against 29% urban (gender gap). No earlier figure is held, so the level is on the record and the direction is not, and nothing is held on what is being done about it: no target, no programme and no gender-disaggregated figure for identity enrolment, account ownership or device access.	NO CHANGE a first measurement with no earlier figure behind it

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs	A refugee-inclusion framework covering 1.1m refugees and 2m displaced people makes the national identity central to a state-led model. The framework adopted in July 2026 puts the national identity at the centre of a state-led inclusion model covering 1.1m refugees and 2m internally displaced people (inclusion framework). The lender's March 2026 mission records about 190,000 refugee registrations against 170,000 identity issuances (aide-memoire). Neither figure is broken down by camp, region or status, and the base holds nothing on what services a refugee holding the identity can actually reach.	ADVANCED
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides	A 1.5% revenue levy funds universal access, and handset financing targets up to two million smartphones a year. From March 2026 both operators contribute 1.5% of revenue to a universal access fund, about 2.5bn birr a year (access fund levy). Financing deals with two banks target up to two million handsets a year for low-income customers on long-term instalments (handset financing). A telco-agnostic wallet launched in December 2025 works on a subscriber module from any network and is verified against the national identity, removing network lock-in (the wallet). Nothing is published on what the access fund has disbursed, on how many handsets have been financed, or on the gap either is meant to close.	ADVANCED

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics		NO EVIDENCE
National statistics	Censuses and surveys		NO EVIDENCE
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data		NO EVIDENCE
Open data	Use of open data		NO EVIDENCE
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	A United States health memorandum signed in December 2025 plans US\$1,016,000,000 of support to 2030 against Ethiopia's US\$450,000,000. The memorandum covers activities from April 2026 to December 2030, states at clause 6.9 that it is not an international agreement, and was signed on the Ethiopian side by the Minister of Finance (memorandum). The United States reserves 6% of the top-line budget for its own management and operations (the same text). It is the only United States or hyperscaler engagement held: no cloud provider agreement, technology company memorandum or bilateral digital instrument is on file.	ADVANCED
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	The country is a founding member of a Shanghai-based artificial intelligence body and opened vendor tracks on cloud and data centres in July 2026. Ethiopia is one of 29 founding states of the organisation, announced with 5,000 Chinese-funded training places over five years and support for joint open-source model development (founding membership). The constitutive text, membership list, powers, funding, voting rules and whether the agreement binds are all unestablished. The incumbent operator opened scoping discussions with its radio-network vendor covering cloud, artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, data-centre services and wallet integration, with no value or term disclosed (vendor scoping), and a separate data-centre track with a Chinese manufacturer, with no site or value stated (data-centre track). One Chinese model accounts for about 20% of chatbot use in the country, the top of its African range (model adoption).	ADVANCED
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments	An Indian state rail telecom company announced a data centre build in January 2026, with nothing published since. The announcement is a press release from the Indian company stating an intention to build a data centre (announcement). No site, capacity, value, partner, timetable or Ethiopian counterparty is named, and the base holds no other Indian engagement, so the record is one press release and its silence since.	ADVANCED

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Third mobile network operator licence	An Ethiopian Communications Authority licensing round, tender or ministerial decision on a third full operator licence.	2026-08-04
Gulf digital cooperation	An MoU, investment or ministerial readout naming a Gulf state counterparty in Ethiopian digital infrastructure, AI or payments.	2026-08-04
Audit of digital spending for any in-scope year	An Office of the Federal Auditor General report for EFY 2017 or later; its published library stops at EFY 2016.	2026-08-04
Independent data-protection safeguards over the national digital identity	a published data-protection impact assessment for the national digital identity, a statutory limit on state access to its data, or a redress mechanism a registrant could use	2026-08-09

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